

sa

Homeschooling

ISSUE 7, 2021

LIVING & LEARNING – TOGETHER

+PLUS:

Attitude with gratitude
Homeschooling systems

Final round creative
writing competition
winners

Study
tips for
the New
Year

**THE JOY
OF HOLISTIC
LEARNING**

31

days of
fun family
activities,
adventures
& projects

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happy holidays
special moments
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Homeschooling*

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online school



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Kezia, Grade 8

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What's in a name? In SA *Homeschooling*'s instance, there's more than meets the eye.



Since we opened our own 'homeschooling classroom' at the end of November last year, we've been delighted to see parental support, enthusiasm and feedback grow and glow. Our brand supporters, contributors, homeschooling experts

and social media homeschooling friends – far and wide – have given us continual, invaluable and exciting insights and inspiration.

Homeschooling has become synonymous with our ever-changing world which so many have courageously embraced, as have the learning options and resources. It's a community, a family and a unique ecosystem which we're very proud to be part of and connected to.

And as anyone in a successful community will attest to, 'teamwork makes the dream work'. SA *Homeschooling* is no exception to this apt adage. The team is passionate about producing an engaging, meaningful and accessible resource tool to help you manage your children's education while nurturing precious family relationships.

We look forward to continuing with you on your homeschooling journey as you live and learn together.

Stay safe and have a happy and blessed holiday season!

Jason





Ed's note

As we've gradually – and, hopefully, permanently – moved out of lockdown life, a new way of living has emerged: more parents work from home, more children are homeschooled and our values have shifted from 'we want more' to 'we want better'. And that's what this issue is all about and what we wish for you over the holidays: closer relationships, true sharing and gifts from the heart.

Shelagh
Editor

Contributors



JENA RAUBENHEIMER

As a professor at the Dept of Psychology at the UJ, Jena specialised in developmental psychology, authored several publications and read academic papers worldwide. As co-founder of StudySmart, she emphasises the development of inquisitive minds, a positive outlook and the value of developing unique talents.

www.studysmart.org.za



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www.optimi.co.za



TESSA VENTER

Tessa is Head of School for St Stithians Online School (SSOS). She has degrees in journalism and education and has taught in international and local contexts. She loves reading, travelling and has recently attempted to start gardening. She is married to Adriaan and they have a daughter, Charlotte.

www.ststithiansonlineschool.com



DALENA VAN DER WESTHUIZEN

Co-founder and Managing Director of BrainAbility SA, Cognitive Development Specialist, Master Brain Coach and internationally Certified Cognitive Coach. Dalena takes the latest international research and best practice and translates it into strategies that can be applied by parents and educators.

www.brainability.co.za | www.facebook.com/BrainAbilitySA

Editor-in-Chief Jason Aarons
jason@isikhova.co.za

Editor Shelagh Foster
shelagh@isikhova.co.za

Managing Director Imraan Mahomed
imraan@isikhova.co.za

Director: Brand Strategy Jenny Justus
jenny@isikhova.co.za | 083 450 6052

Creative Director Joanne Brook
joanne@isikhova.co.za

Operations Director Thuli Majola
thuli@isikhova.co.za

Pictures Editor Amahle Jali

Copy Editor Anne Phillips

Media Specialist Ruwayda Mahomed
ruwayda@isikhova.co.za | 072 383 3203

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Subscriptions & General Enquiries:
sahomeschooling@isikhova.co.za

Find us on Facebook and Instagram

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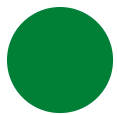
FUNtastic festive food

Who says it's bad to play with your food? These creative delights will keep your children occupied for hours



Active Home Education Institute

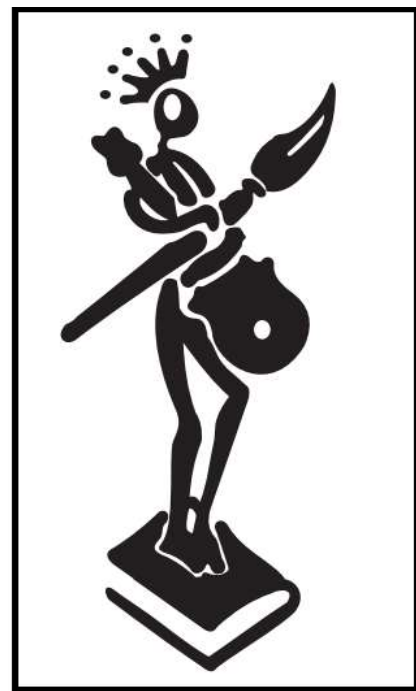
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31 happy holiday days

What with empty wallets and the still-present threat of Covid-19 preventing many from enjoying a proper summer holiday, we thought it was time to bring you 31 days of fun family activities, adventures and projects this December

In no particular order...

DAY 1. Devise your own family exercise programme: dancing one day, hula-hooping the next, yoga stretches the next. You get the picture.

DAY 2. Explore local parks that you don't normally visit.

DAY 3. Make up a board game.

DAY 4. Google the local historic or geographic sites and become a tourist in your own town.

DAY 5. Make a family movie: decide on the story, allocate characters, appoint a director and push 'record'.

DAY 6. Have a karaoke night. Invite (or warn!) the neighbours.

DAY 7. Head off on the nearest nature trail.

DAY 8. Make fluffy slime (feeling is believing). Visit: www.thebestideasforkids.com/fluffy-slime-recipe

DAY 9. Download the Duolingo app and learn a new or local language. Duolingo also has great free teaching tools.

DAY 10. Have a water balloon fight (preferably outside!).

DAY 11. Find something you're all interested in and become experts (insects, flying, the moon, Picasso – the choice is endless).

DAY 12. Go to a local sporting event – even if you don't normally follow that sport.

DAY 13. Make a fire in the garden and tell spooky (but not *too* spooky) stories.

DAY 14. Do a 'green assessment' of your house and garden and explore ways of becoming more environmentally friendly.

DAY 15. Set up a campsite in your garden and spend the night there.



DAY 16. Dedicate a day – or two – to clearing out all your junk and take the good stuff to your local charity shop.

DAY 17. Teach the little ones to make a meal: cheese, biscuits and chopped fruit will do!

DAY 18. Get up just before dawn one morning and watch the stars fade as the sun comes up.

DAY 19. Download a star-tracking app (SkyView is free) and get to know the night sky.



#FUNFACT

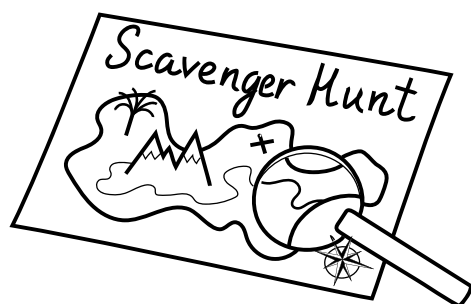
Quality family time improves child's academic performance.

DAY 20. Buy everyone a sketchpad (www.cna.co.za/product/sketch-pad-a3-40-sheet-120g/) and pencils and challenge your kids to draw one picture a day.

DAY 21. Find out what kinds of foods are appropriate for your local feathered friends and set up a bird-feeding station.



DAY 22. Sort out the family photos and have them printed on canvas (www.canvasandmore.co.za/) or create a calendar (www.thoughtco.com/make-your-own-photo-calendar-1420723).



DAY 23. Tell your children stories about when you were little (and naughty!).

Get together with neighbouring families and:

DAY 24. Create a scavenger hunt (www.scarymommy.com/ways-to-explore-your-neighborhood-adventure/).

DAY 25. Hold a talent contest (the kind in which everyone's a winner).

DAY 26. Put on a 'bad taste' fashion show.

DAY 27. To get cheaper seats, make a block booking for a child-friendly show at your local theatre.

DAY 28. Have a boerie roll braai competition – dads vs kids!

DAY 29. Arm yourselves with gloves, black bags and masks and do a neighbourhood clean-up.

DAY 30. Bake cakes and take them to the local homeless shelter or care home.

DAY 31. Organise a safely socially distanced Christmas or Happy Holidays party for the neighbourhood. (You'll find great cheapie gift ideas on p24.)



HANDY LINKS

- www.capetownmagazine.com/free-and-cheap-things-in-cape-town-kids
- www.insideguide.co.za/cape-town/to-do-kids/
- www.citizen.co.za/lifestyle/2478261/fun-activities-in-durban-for-the-upcoming-school-holidays/Durban
- www.travelstart.co.za/blog/fun-things-to-do-bloemfontein/
- www.becomingyou.co.za/top-10-things-to-do-with-kids-near-east-london/
- www.tripadvisor.co.za/Attractions-g312559-Activities-zft11306-Port_Elizabeth_Eastern_Cape.html
- www.getaway.co.za/travel-ideas/kids-things-to-do-school-holidays-johannesburg/
- www.joburgtheatre.com
- www.thingstodowithkids.co.za



The joy of holistic learning

On its simplest level, holistic development encourages you to use an activity that your child loves to create an opportunity for learning

That all sounds pretty easy, but how can you do it at home? These are the basics:

Ask open-ended questions

Learning is experimental. By asking open-ended questions, you're allowing children to think for themselves and explore their thoughts with cognitive reasoning, rather than a simple 'yes' or 'no' answer. Let them explore their train of thought and see how their thinking develops.

Build positive relationships

Children form more powerful and nurturing relationships and



communicate better when they can connect with people they trust. By ensuring that you create a learning environment in which teachers, coaches and tutors will form a positive bond with your child, you're creating a strong and safe community – a space to learn and grow.

Identify your child's interests

Knowing your child's interests and understanding what motivates them will help you guide them to discovering their identity and purpose in life through their



connections to the natural world, thereby creating positive values and sparking their curiosity.

One way of doing this is by **taking** a small idea and **expanding** on it to broaden its learning opportunities.

Example: Take an object as simple as a plain old Lion match and make it the subject of intense investigation by exploring:

What it consists of and how it works (science).

Where it originated and how long it's been around (history, geography, commerce).

Where the word 'match' comes from (language, etymology).

What wood is used (agriculture, forestry).

The size and shape of the match; how you can create endless designs and patterns with a box of matches (art, design, geometry).

This method can be applied to just about anything and is a truly fun way of finding out what your child **wants** to know more about.

Provide an inviting space

Create a comfortable environment in which your children can be themselves and comfortably connect with others.

Make it inviting with the use of colour, child-friendly furniture, interest corners and space for creative play.

As you can see, holistic learning isn't an alternative to other forms of education, but rather a mindset of 'wholeness', of the joy of learning. This is something from which we can all benefit.



Staying on top of executive functions

The struggles that come with weak executive functioning skills won't lessen during the holidays. For many, they're worse, writes **Dalena van der Westhuizen** of BrainAbility

1 Establish and maintain an easy-to-follow daily routine

During the holiday period, a consistent daily routine is usually the first thing that goes out the window. However, inconsistent routines are tough for children with executive function struggles. Establish a basic routine that fits in with your specific circumstances and will be easy to stick to (most days).

2 Plan ahead (when you can)

Children with weak executive functioning skills find it difficult to plan and organise. Whether it's visiting family, going to the beach, shopping, etc, warn your child about upcoming activities. A visual planner like a basic calendar works well, or give them a verbal reminder the evening before.

3 Use a checklist

Whether you need to pack for a family visit or an outing, there are things to be done beforehand. Getting a child with weak executive function skills to take part and assume

responsibility for some of these tasks is much easier if you let them use a simple checklist.

4 Limit choices

When kids with executive function challenges are faced with too many choices, they can easily become overwhelmed. To ease the decision-making process, offer only two or three choices when it comes to food, places to visit, what to wear, etc.

5 Break down instructions and tasks into smaller, manageable pieces

Children with weak executive function skills usually struggle with working memory, which enables them to hold all the information for the current task in mind and process it at the same time, in the correct sequence. These children battle to remember, or follow, multi-step instructions and processes. They also struggle with task initiation. Getting started is difficult.

Make life easier for everyone by keeping instructions short and direct and by breaking down bigger tasks into smaller, manageable pieces.

(Don't miss ['Is your child lazy?' in SAH #6](#) for more on executive functioning skills.)

Enjoy the holidays!



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- Daniel Goleman -

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MORE**



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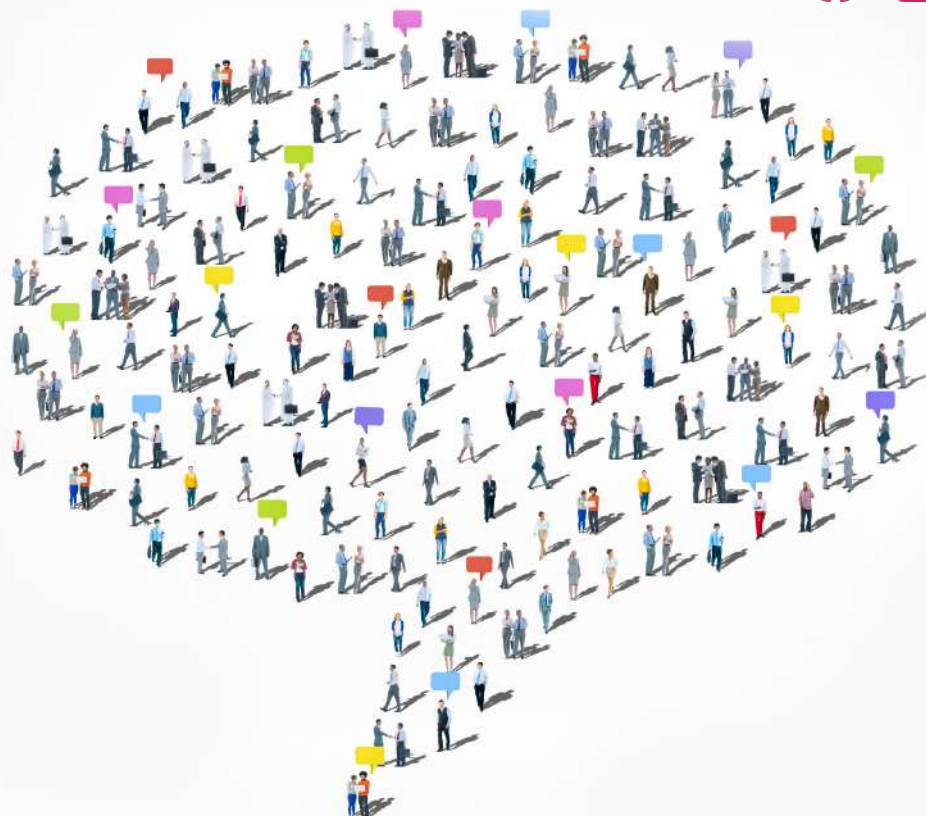
CAMBRILEARN

CHAT TO US!

Your **feedback is essential** in helping us put together a magazine which delivers on-point content relevant to your homeschooling experiences and support needs and **helps you navigate** your child/children's education with ease and confidence.

You are the **core** of the publication, so let's live and learn together.

Email our editor, Shelagh Foster,
at: shelagh@isikhova.co.za.



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When deciding how you're going to homeschool, it helps to look at three things: what kind of person you are intellectually, what kind of person your child is intellectually and which system best suits your lifestyle. Here's a broad outline of the main homeschooling systems and how they might work for your family.

Classical

The main difference between classical homeschooling and other forms is that it separates learning into three stages, collectively called the *trivium* (Latin for ‘where the road meets’).

The first stage creates an opportunity to impart concrete facts, the foundation children need to continue learning and growing. It focuses on memory and repetition to form the building blocks for the next stage.

In the next stage, children move on to analytical thinking, questioning why things are the way they are and the logic behind this. They also use this time to figure out how everything they've learnt fits together and relates.

The last stage of the *trivium* is rhetoric: using the knowledge and logic they've learnt up to this point and learning how to express themselves with original thought. Children begin to explore abstract thought and hypothetical situations.



Choosing the system

Classical, Charlotte Mason, Montessori, school-at-home, unschooling or eclectic – which one is best for your child?

Classical homeschooling is often – but not always – linked to religious organisation.
– *Homeeducator.com*

Unschooling

Unschooling – or
freeschooling – essentially
follows the interests of
your children. There's no
curriculum or set structure.
If your children want to learn
about space travel, you'll

dedicate time to exploring all aspects of that topic before moving on to the next one. If they want to learn to play a musical instrument, that becomes a part of their learning. Gardening becomes a botany lesson, etc.

While unschooling often produces children with a deep and wide knowledge of many things, it doesn't include



tertiary education-readiness, which is worth bearing in mind if you choose to go this route.

School-at-home

School-at-homers are what most people imagine homeschoolers to be. They use a credible curriculum with recognised qualification outcomes. They either set up a home workplace for online study and/or their children attend a small 'classroom' or 'cottage school'. Generally, both textbooks and computers are used. Field trips, team sports and group outings encourage socialising, while online tutors may form part of the programme.

Charlotte Mason

Mason was a British educator in the late 1800s and early 1900s who emphasised respecting each child as a person and giving them a broad education. Her approach works with the way children naturally learn and presents a generous curriculum, including nature study, art and music



appreciation, and handicrafts, as well as the usual academic subjects. It seeks to 'spread a feast' before the child and let them digest what's appropriate for them at the time. It uses methods that will nurture a love for learning and

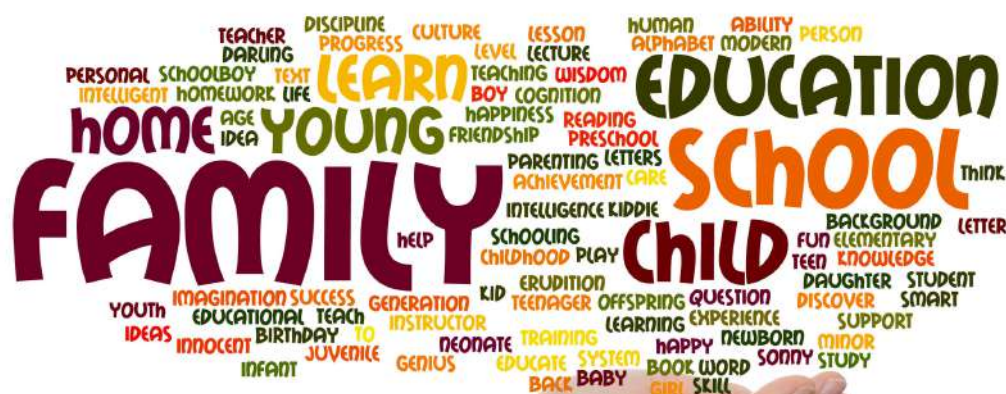
reinforce good, lifelong habits,
rather than simply presenting a
body of information.

This style of homeschooling uses rich literature and ‘living books’ rather than textbooks. Instead of worksheets or answering questions in the back of the book, it asks the student to retell everything they can remember from the reading.

– *simplycharlottemason.com*

Eclectic

This system has become very popular because it allows parents to design a schedule with their children's unique personalities in mind. You know best what your kids like and what they find interesting. You probably also feel that some topics are particularly important or engaging and eclectic homeschooling gives you a great avenue to focus on those topics. As you design your schedule and curriculum, you can adopt methods that fit well with your family's style and leave out anything that doesn't fit. It's a highly personalised, customised approach.



Montessori

Montessori has long been a much-loved pre-primary system and the holistic and scientifically proven learning methods developed by Dr Maria Montessori can now be applied throughout your child's homeschooling journey.

Madeline Hoban, Head of Research & Development at InHome Montessori, says: 'Parents looking for a home curriculum that extends beyond just the academic development of a child will find that InHome Montessori embeds all the basic principles of whole-child development.'

'The programme incorporates executive functioning skills like planning, self-control and working memory within the parameters of respect for the child, creativity, freedom and social skills.'

'Research has proven that active parental involvement in the formative pre-school years is an indicator of lifelong social, emotional and academic success. The InHome Montessori curriculum has been designed as a mechanism for parents to confidently impact their child's ongoing learning journey in the peace of mind that they've given their child the best start in life.'



Helpful links

www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7Qrm4urOrY

www.inhomemontessori.com/

www.sanhisa.wordpress.com/

www.sanhisa.wordpress.com/2021/09/22/elf-directed-education/

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Traditional school vs homeschool mom

Remember the days when you were a run-off-your-feet traditional schooling (TS) parent? No? Well, here's a little reminder of why life is just that bit saner when you're doing it the HS (homeschooling) way



Waking thoughts

TS: Oh, no! I've overslept – and what was it Jared was supposed to take to school this morning that I promised I'd buy yesterday?

HS: Darn, I forgot to get that world atlas at CNA yesterday. We'll just have to switch 'countries and flags' to tomorrow.

Getting dressed

TS: Bra? Check! Hair? Check! Lipstick? Check! Sunglasses to hide yesterday's smudged mascara? Check!

HS: Don't you just love pyjamas that double as leisurewear?



Meals

TS: If I never have to pack another lunchbox in my life, I'll die happy.

HS: Since we're going to be doing vitamins and minerals today, I think I'll teach the kids how to make a yummy fruit salad.



Me-time

TS: Yay! I have a whole 25 minutes between dropping the kids off at school and my first Zoom call of the day.

HS: Yay! It's quiet reading hour, kids. Remember, no chatting or fighting! I'll be on the verandah with Deon Meyer if there's an emergency.

Uniforms

TS: I'm spending more on uniforms than on textbooks. Will this absurdity ever end?

HS: Yes, darling, your sister's old Barbie T-shirt goes beautifully with your camo pants.

Learning

TS: So, history of Limpopo Province test on Monday, geography of Southern Australia test on Wednesday, tribes of the Amazon test on Friday. No wonder you're stressed out, Lucy.

HS: Guys, come and help me put together next week's programme. We're going to explore the history, agriculture, coastline and cultures of New Zealand. What fun!



Transport

TS: I'm spending more on petrol than on groceries these days. Will this *schlepping* ever end?

HS: Guys, we're going on a nature walk today. Last one at the gate carries the backpack with the homegrown veggie smoothies!

Schedule

TS: Thuli, sweetie, Jo's timetable's just been changed and I'm now fetching him from extra maths at 4pm, so I'll only be able to pick you up from karate at 4.30pm. Please make sure you wait inside the hall for me.

HS: Jo, sweetie, your online maths tutor wants to change your time to 4pm, so are you okay doing the class in the car while we go and pick up Thuli from karate? Don't forget your headphones!



SAH chats to the head of St Stithians Online School (SSOS), **Tessa Venter**, about what makes this education offering the ideal fit for homeschoolers

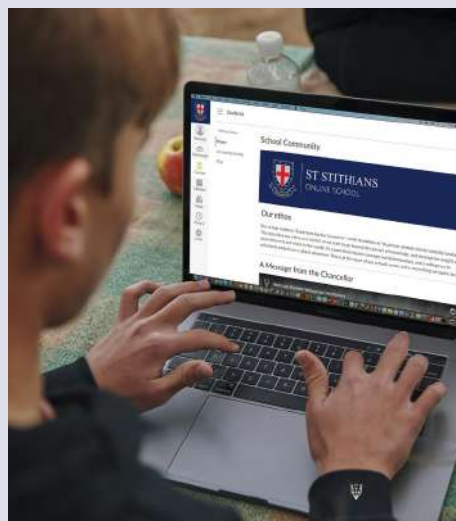
What makes SSOS unique in South Africa?

St Stithians Online School is the eighth school at St Stithians College and there are many elements of our incredible space that make us unique. I've highlighted two:

Our mentor system is the backbone of our students' success. Each student is allocated a dedicated mentor for their time at SSOS who provides pastoral care. Our mentors have backgrounds in



SSOS is the answer



psychology and their entire focus is on the well-being of our students and ensuring that SSOS is a place where students thrive.

Secondly, there's our approach to academics. Students attend live classes for all their subjects each week. However, their days don't feature back-to-back lessons. At times when they're not in live sessions, they're expected to be preparing for classes, completing



assignments, booking and attending one-on-one sessions with their teachers, and studying for upcoming tests. As you can see, time management is an important skill!

The approach to this kind of timetabling is one called the 'flipped classroom'.

What local and international study opportunities are open to SSOS graduates?

Our international curriculum and associated external examinations are recognised by 600 top universities across the globe, which means the world really is our students' oyster. In South Africa, top universities recognise and accept international school qualifications. The international qualifications on offer at SSOS do a great deal to equip our students to cope with university.

Do students have opportunities to 'socialise' with other students?

Absolutely! At SSOS we know that socialising is important and part of the learning process. Students have multiple opportunities to socialise, from our virtual clubs to 'Homeroom' and 'Learning Compass' sessions with their mentors and being able to connect with their peers in weekly assemblies. There are multiple opportunities for interaction.

We also have a unique blended learning space at our Johannesburg and Cape Town Boutique Campuses. Students can opt to join a Boutique Campus, where they're physically present to socialise, connect and collaborate, but still have their academic classes online. They really get the best of both worlds.

What three tips can you offer students who're new to online schooling?

a. Make sure you have a dedicated workspace set up where you aren't easily distracted.

b. Engage in optometrist Jeffrey Anshel's 20-20-20 rule, to prevent eye strain in those spending a lot of time online: after every 20 minutes of screen time, look away and pay attention to something about 6m away for 20 seconds.

c. Make purposeful connections! As soon as you don't understand something, reach out to your teacher. If you feel overwhelmed or unsure, connect with your mentor. Connection looks slightly different in the online space, but your teachers and mentors want to hear from you and love connecting with you.

What three tips can you offer parents of students new to online schooling?

a. Ask about their school day. What did they learn? What confused them? What did the hidden

curriculum, the curriculum of life, teach them today?

b. View mistakes and failures as opportunities for growth and areas for improvement. Defining teenagers by how they respond to situations, rather than the situations themselves, creates and facilitates a narrative of hope, acceptance and character.

c. Get involved by attending parent information evenings, subject selection evenings, monitoring your child's grades and assignment submissions and the like, but rest assured that this isn't homeschooling in the traditional sense. We have dedicated teachers and mentors to support your child and you every step of the way, so lean on us.

Our FAQ section on www.ststithiansonlineschool.com has a wealth of commonly asked questions and answers for students and parents interested in a high-quality, high-touch, online schooling transition.



Join the St Stithians family from wherever you may be.



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if different to one you send from.

SA Homeschooling – Living & Learning Together.



Whereas birthdays are all about one person, Christmas is a time for sharing with family and friends. Gift-wise, the trend is moving towards small gifts and tokens, rather than extravagant presents – which is good news on all counts!

Enjoy our great ‘medium-effort/high-thought’ suggestions for everyone from grandparents to toddlers.

Bottle it

Consol jars are the ultimate gift-wrap: re-usable, functional, pretty and practical. Fill them with one or more of the following and add a bright ribbon or tinsel for a winning pressie:

- Hairclips and ties.
- Sweeties.
- Foil-wrapped chocolate balls.
- Asian spices.



Christmas gifts from the heart





- Dried herbs.
- Biltong.
- Bath salts.
- Sample tubes of hand cream, body lotion and make-up.
- Fancy tea.
- Coffee beans.
- Wax crayons.
- Marbles.
- Little toy cars.
- Doll's clothes.
- A mini-sewing kit.
- Homemade [playdough](#).

On the subject of recycling, there's no need to waste money on disposable wrapping paper and Sellotape when, with a little imagination, you can use:

- Old magazine pages.
- Washed and decorated food cans.
- Shweshwe fabric.
- Vintage dish towels/ handkerchiefs.

- Old biscuit or tea tins.
- String.
- Ribbon.
- Raffia.
- Interesting old buttons.

Paper it

A ream (500 sheets) of printer paper costs under R75 and can give months of pleasure to just about anyone. There's so much you can do with it!

For starters, share this link:

www.fabenglish-ideas.com/workshops/30-things-to-do-with-a-piece-of-paper or invite the recipient to write a recipe, a short story or a poem a week, or to draw a picture a day. Before you know it, there could be a book in the making.



#FUNFACT

Tinsel was invented in 1610 in Germany and was originally spun from real silver, making it far from the decoration it is now.

Vouchers

This is a lovely idea for the whole family. Visit:

www.creativecertificates.com/christmas-gift-certificate-templates to create vouchers for all sorts of things:

- Five Saturdays helping in the garden.
- Five evenings of babysitting.
- Five outings to the milkshake parlour.
- Washing breakfast dishes for a week.
- Walking the dog for a month.
- A promise of a tidy bedroom for a month.



- Quiet time with Dad once a week.
- Free labour painting the home classroom.
- An uninterrupted hour on a Sunday morning.

Thoughts

A **word cloud** is a visual of all the words you associate with a certain idea, place or person. Creating your own is a truly beautiful – and frameable – expression of love and appreciation. There are many free resources online, including www.monkeylearn.com/word-cloud.

An **appreciation box** is another nifty idea for the whole family.

Simply cut sheets of coloured paper into strips and write different messages on each one. These can include sentiments like:

- 'You're wonderful!'
- 'I know how hard you work'
- 'I love you'
- 'I admire your courage'
- 'I appreciate everything about you'
- 'You make my heart sing'
- 'You're beautiful', etc.

The more, the merrier!

Then fold each message, pop it into the box and keep it for after Christmas lunch, when everyone gets a chance to





How about introducing your children to the books you used to love as a child? You can pick up old Enid Blyton, Arthur Ransome and Louisa May Alcott titles for next to nothing. Or scour your local charity shops for crystal whisky glasses or vintage vases for grandparents. Warning: once you start the second-hand habit, you can quickly become addicted!

Family games

Instead of getting or making everyone something small, consider splashing out on a board game or activity you can all enjoy. These are all the rage:

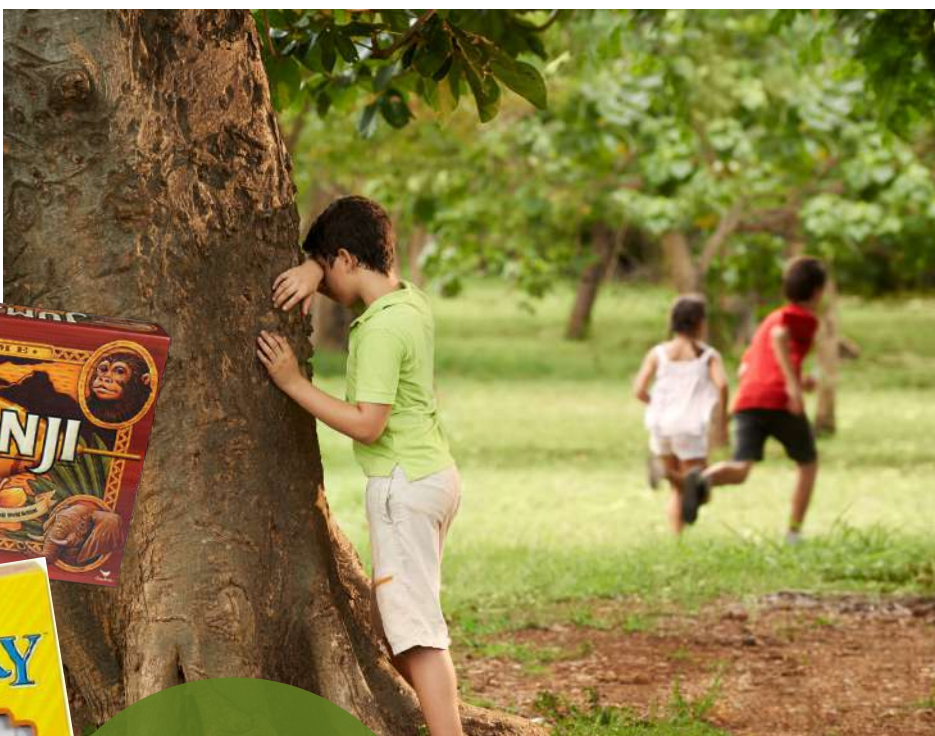
Indoors

- Jumanji.
- Kids' charades.
- Bananagrams.
- A compendium of games.
- Connect 4.
- Richard Scarry's Busytown.
- Pictionary.
- Magimag.

Outdoor

- Boules.
- Mini-cricket.
- Hide-and-seek.
- Swingball.
- Homemade obstacle course.

Whatever you decide to buy, do or make, don't forget that it truly is the thought that counts – and you'll all be in our thoughts this festive season!



'How about introducing your children to the books you used to love as a child?'

draw two or three strips and read them aloud.

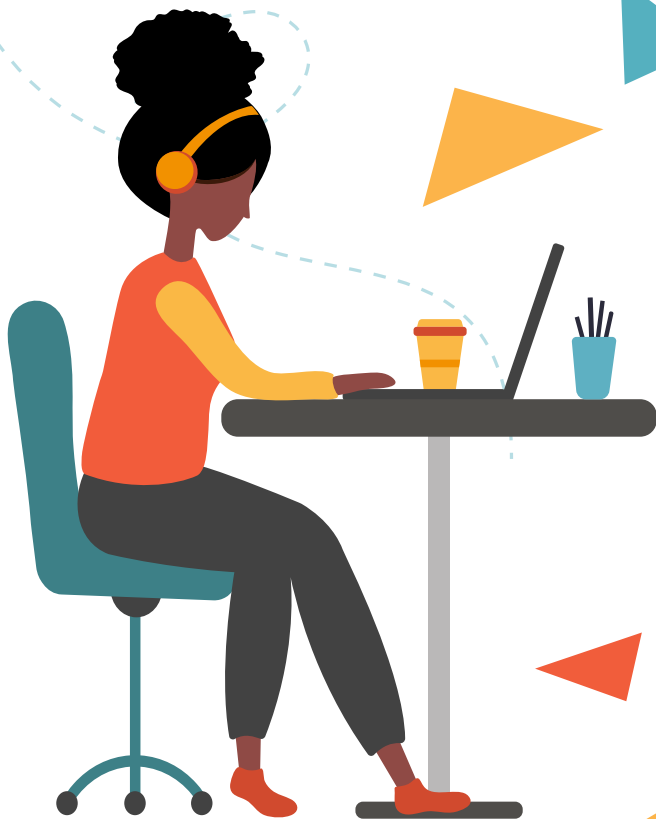
Find it

If you're not iffy about used goods, charity shops, flea markets and second-hand bookstores are often perfect places to find perfect gifts.



WINGU ACADEMY

CHALLENGING EXPECTATIONS ABOUT SCHOOLING FROM HOME THROUGH EXCELLENCE AND INNOVATION



Due to the global pandemic and the subsequent disruptions in the traditional schooling environment, home-schooling, and specifically online schooling enrolment has seen a significant rise. With the concern for their children's health, coupled with the flexibility and convenience that online home-schooling offers, it has become a viable option for many parents. Wingu Academy (wingu-academy.com) has arguably the most advanced distance and blended learning platform in the online space in Africa.

Their remote-learning platform offers educational support to schools, tutoring centres and home-schoolers across the globe, with live classes and tutorials, interactive online content that is aligned with the major British International Curriculum boards (including being a registered as a Pearson Edexcel online centre) catering for qualifications for learners between the ages of 6 – 19 years building up to the General Certificate of Secondary Education (GCSE) and AS/A-levels with a focus on developing fourth industrial revolution skills. After finishing these exams, students are welcome to apply at the leading institutions such as the top 100 Universities in the world.

Their platform gives educational support to anyone schooling from home from across the globe, between the ages of 6 – 19 years. Live classes and tutorials are presented along with interactive online content. The platform aims to enrich learners with 4th Industrial Revolution (4IR) skills such as critical thinking, creativity, complex problem solving and online collaboration.

The ever-evolving Wingu platform provides the internationally recognised British curriculum and as of January 2023, Wingu Academy will extend their high-school offering to include the South African CAPS curriculum. Wingu Academy officially launched in July 2020 and soon after joined TuksNovation (The University of Pretoria's High Tech Incubator and Accelerator) where it has been housed ever since.

The most advanced blended learning
platform for schooling from home

Stages 1-9 | GCSE | AS/A Levels



Developed by teachers and subject area experts who hold advanced degrees in respective fields, and in collaboration with researchers at the Wits School of Education, Wingu prepares students for an international curriculum that is relevant and accredited globally. There is a focus on blended, student-led learning, gamification and instant constructive feedback and continuous assessments.

Wingu Academy focuses on a blended learning approach that includes asynchronous (self-paced, student-led) and synchronous (interactive live classes) learning, enriched with animations, video content, infographics, gamification and simulations to cater for the major types of learning styles (visual, auditory, reading/writing, kinaesthetic learning styles) and implementing constructive feedback in continuous assessments providing a wide variety of choices to support individual learning at home. The learners are exposed to computation thinking from as early as Grade/Stage 1, and the coding and robotics courses culminate into industry relevant software development certificates for the high school learners, increasing their employability and readiness for the Future of Work.

They are also very proud to announce the launch of WinguNet. "The launch of WinguNet has been much anticipated and serves to address the need of stable, high-speed internet in areas where there is poor or no coverage," says Ian Strydom, Wingu Academy Managing Director.

The introduction of WinguNet to the range of services delivered by Wingu Academy further indicates how in tune they are with the needs of parents and students.

"This will be introduced to the existing parents and students first on the platform who struggle with connectivity, thereafter being rolled out with the mission of connecting and educating students in difficult-to-reach, isolated areas. This satellite initiative is the first of its kind – just another way that Wingu stays true to their principles of advancing education and enabling excellence," Strydom concludes.

The platform is well suited for full-time learners, global citizens that travel frequently, star athletes that need to focus on training but still want an internationally recognised education, and students that would like to obtain entrance to university degrees either locally or abroad.

Many parents may be worried that their children will miss out on social interaction, but they still get to meet friends and even form study groups as they are not bound by geographical borders. In fact, Wingu also offers a variety of social clubs varying from fitness, chess to photography and parents have the opportunity to become involved too.

Student well-being, particularly mental health, is at the heart of Wingu's core foundation. Their Wellness Hub is expanding to offer professional guidance to both students and parents in areas of concern, as well as leadership initiatives for the learners.

Wingu Academy's innovative strategy is at the forefront of equipping students for the 4IR with a forward-thinking strategy of anywhere, anytime, staying connected and offering the future classroom today!

Enrolments to start schooling in January 2022 are now open.

Visit their website at

www.wingu-academy.com

or go to

www.wingu-academy.com/book-now/
to book a free consultation now.



 **info@wingu-academy.com**

 **www.wingu-academy.com**

 **087 550 5169**  **068 476 8937**

Do you want a one-on-one session with an admissions specialist to find out more?

Scan the code to book a free consultation.





Why study attitude matters

As a child, would you have done anything rather than open a textbook? Was schoolwork often a source of conflict in your family? If so, how can you make learning a more rewarding and productive experience for your own children, asks **Dr Jena Raubenheimer**, Executive Director of Study Smart?

The key lies in the difference between study skills and study attitude.

There are many courses on how to master the 'hard' study skills such as time management and creating good summaries. These are especially valuable in the short term and can improve a child's performance significantly.

However, simply showing children with a poor attitude towards schoolwork the right study methods is likely to be a futile exercise. They may know what to do, but their negativity means they're not even remotely motivated to master and apply those methods.

It's equally important that your children develop an underlying

'A parent's strongest tool is the example they set by showing how deeply satisfying it is to possess and share knowledge.'

love for knowledge and an inquisitive mind that will last and benefit them for the rest of their lives. And nobody's better equipped than you to guide and accompany them on this fulfilling journey. The question is: how?

Here are three proven ways in which you can constructively influence your child to develop a positive mindset towards learning:

Be the right role model

What kind of intellectual model are you to your children? Are you an intellectually passive person who spends most of your time in front of the TV? Or are you somebody who displays problem-solving skills and enjoys intellectual challenges? Do they see you using Google to find answers?

What's your attitude towards your own work? Do you actively model enthusiasm, conscientiousness and job satisfaction, or do your children see an exhausted and disgruntled parent at the end of your working day?

Demonstrate curiosity

Children should associate their parents with problem-solving skills and the attributes to know more and understand better. These qualities should be visible to your children.

It's great to occasionally play challenging board games with your kids, but you can share your experience and knowledge with

them informally many times a day. In the car, chat to them: be perceptive, ask questions and encourage them to Google if they (or you) don't know the answers. More than this, the real value lies in the reasons for the answer. Ask: 'Why?', then prompt your child to suggest a possible explanation.



Give positive support and make schoolwork enjoyable

It's easy to make studying unpleasant if anxiety tends to build up around schoolwork, or if we allow the atmosphere to become electrically laden during exams. In the same way, undesirably high levels of tension are created when parents demand too much of their children. Consequently, those children tend to push themselves too hard to try to please their parents.

A parent's strongest tool is the example they set by showing

how deeply satisfying it is to possess and share knowledge and by joining in their children's joy and excitement when they do well in an assessment or task. Parents should acknowledge this feeling of satisfaction in their children and give them the opportunity to experience it, as well as share it. Positive feelings are immensely powerful and provide strong motivation.

A concluding note

Whatever complicating issues there might be, it's important to bear in mind that attitudes are learnt and developed over time. You, as a parent, are in the ideal position to help your child develop a positive attitude towards knowledge, in general and study, specifically; an attitude that will encourage the values of perseverance and hard work. A positive study attitude brings its own rewards.



1 Self-explanation

Come up with explanations, in your own words, of to-be-learnt concepts or ideas. Rather than solely relying on exact provided definitions (eg from lectures or textbooks), create your own, while still making sure that they're accurate.

2 Use a timer

This is called the Pomodoro technique. Set a timer for 20-25 minutes and start studying. When the buzzer rings, take a five-minute break. After two to three repetitions, take a 30-minute break.

Repeat!

3 Interleaving

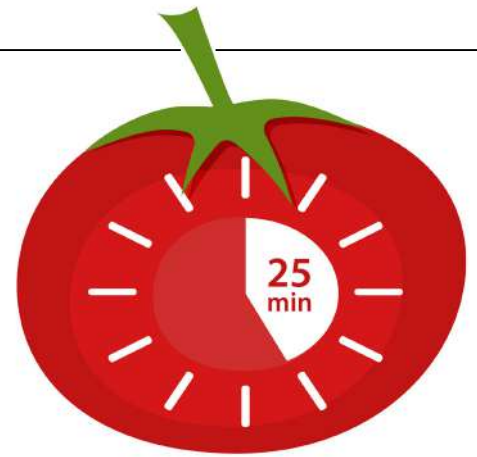
Instead of focusing exclusively on one concept or subject at a time, alternate between them. For example, if you're studying subject A and subject B, rather than practising only A on one day and only B on the next, you can practise both each day by switching between them.

Dig deeper

4

It's hard to remember a string of facts and figures if you don't push further. Ask questions like 'Why?' and 'How?' This is called elaboration. Elaboration helps you combine new information with other things you know and creates a bigger network in your brain of things that relate to one another. That larger network makes it easier to learn and remember things.

Top study tips for 2022



With a new academic year looming – and the first year of tertiary study for some – it's time to unlock possibilities with these 10 research-based tips. By **Dalena van der Westhuizen** of BrainAbility



5

Be the 'teacher'

Research shows students have better memory and recall abilities when they learn new information with the expectation of having to teach/explain it to someone else. Studies also suggest they're more engaged and instinctively seek out methods of recall and organisation when expected to take on a 'teacher' role.



6

Exercise helps learning

The benefits of exercise on the brain have been well established. Studies show that our brainpower gets a boost following even a short workout. According to Dr Douglas B McKeag, breaking a sweat shortly before cracking the books can make you more alert, open and able to learn new information during your post-workout study session.

7

Reading and re-reading isn't studying

Reading and re-reading textbooks merely leads students to assuming they know the material better than they do, since it's right in front of them. Rather use active recall: closing the book and reciting (and explaining) in your own words

everything you can remember up to that point will help with long-term memorisation.

8

Test yourself

Take advantage of old exam and test papers. You'll get a sense of different testing styles and become familiar with how the information might be presented on the real test/exam day. A 2011 study found that students who did this after studying the material retained 50% more of the information a week later than their peers who hadn't done a practice test/exam.

9

Don't over-study

Once you've cycled through your work without making a mistake (or too many mistakes), you may feel a sense of satisfaction and call it a day, or you may feel a charge of adrenaline and be tempted to continue studying the same material. Research suggests it's better to take a break or move on to something else, instead of over-studying.

10

Stop multi-tasking

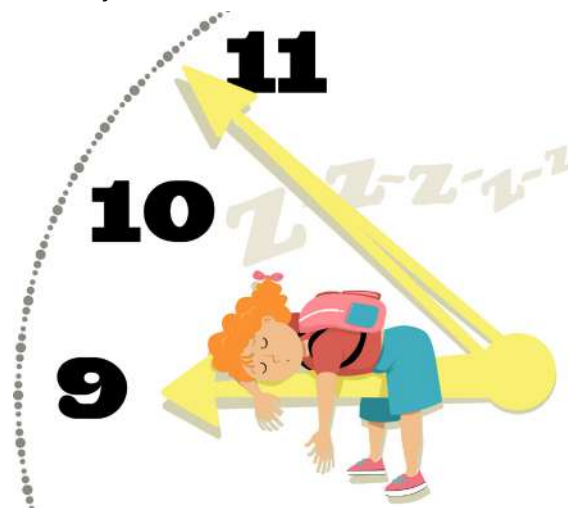
Multi-tasking is a myth. You may think you're killing two birds with one stone by texting or quickly checking your Facebook page while studying, for example, but you're actually forming poor study habits. It's also not useful having your cellphone on silent, yet frequently checking for new messages, or looking at it every time it vibrates to indicate a new message.



According to researchers, 'multi-tasking' extends study time and could ultimately damage your grades. Switch it off and put it somewhere out of sight.

Lastly, remember that **sleep is crucial for studying**. There's even a term for it: *sleep-learning*. As the memory-consolidation process does its best work during slow-wave sleep, your brain could be getting both the restoration and reactivation it needs during its time of rest. So don't even think about studying through the night instead of getting some much-needed sleep.

Here's to a new year, new possibilities and new, better ways to study!



Relentless tech innovations have fundamentally changed the world of work. So much so that we're educating our children today for jobs that don't yet exist and parents of GenZ and GenAlpha children increasingly understand that they need to be educated in different ways.

Mark Anderson, Principal of Koa Academy, a uniquely high-touch digital school, calls this School 2.0. He says: 'Content memorisation, with the teacher as the sole content expert, is an outdated notion for our current young generations, who live in a world where all content is just a click away. Top marks shouldn't just be given for memorising the facts. Instead, being able to evaluate and think critically about an abundance of facts, and the sources of those facts, is one of the vital 21st-century skills.'

The so-called 'soft skills' that nobody paid much attention to in a mechanistic, industrial past have now become the top information-



Why GenZ and GenAlpha need to do school differently

age capabilities. Those who know how to think critically, how to communicate, how to collaborate and how to innovate lead the way. Literacy has expanded to include media, information, civic and technological literacies. Qualities such as resilience, emotional intelligence and flexibility help our children win the day. What this means is that as parents, we should be worried if our child's educational environment today looks and seems a lot like the one we experienced.

Your kids are ready for School 2.0 – but are you?

Anderson believes it's time for parents to find out more about School 2.0. 'It's really exciting that parents have more options than ever when it comes to education. But we also know that it's harder than ever for parents to really



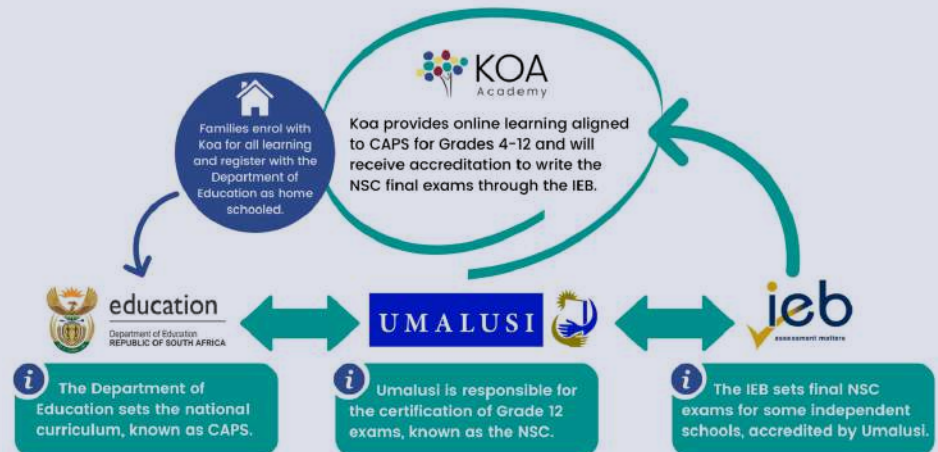
understand those different options. At Koa Academy, our advice to parents is to start by thinking through what you really want for your child. And I don't mean which schooling system: I mean, what do you value when it comes to your child's education?' he asks.

Koa Academy education model prioritises individualised learning, with children grouped in small eight-person pods working every day with a dedicated, specialist teacher who has not only mastered online pedagogy, but understands the needs of each child in their pod. The platform is registered as a South African IEB curriculum provider leveraging educational resources from all over the world. With the flexibility that only an online platform can provide, academic progress is mastery-based, enabling children to speed up or slow down as needed and for families to schedule timetables and terms in ways that suit them best.

'Our aim is to prepare children for the real world,' says Anderson. 'Learning is rooted in real-world issues; tasks give children options and age-appropriate feedback is ongoing so that children can adapt and grow in dynamic ways as they learn. In this way, assessment is embedded in the learning process, rather than a disconnected result that they can't actually learn from. Our passionate teachers are curating and facilitating content

at the child's pace. Each child progresses when they've mastered the learning – which is the only real way to ensure that no-one's left behind.'

Discover Koa Academy at:
<http://www.koaacademy.com/>

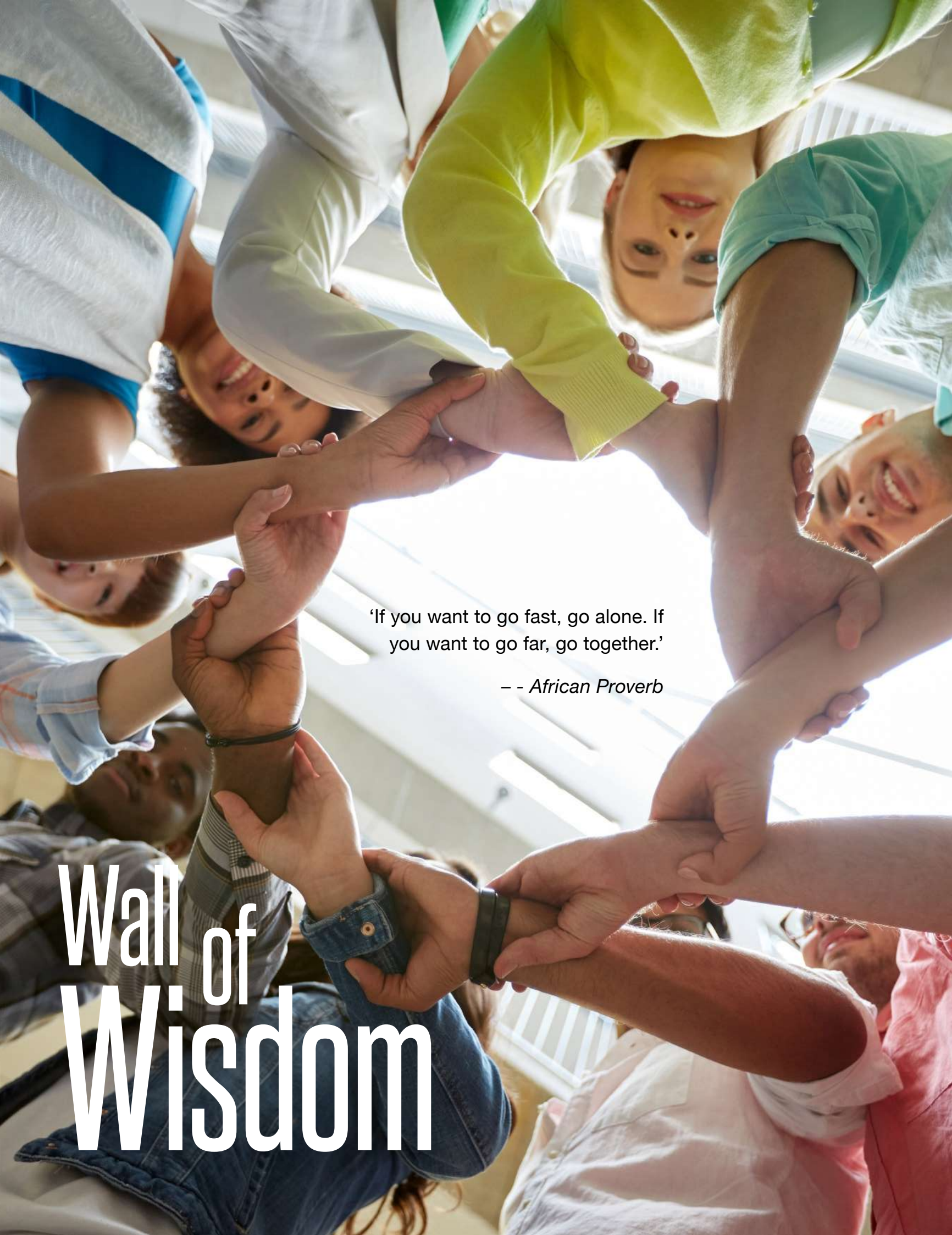


About Koa Academy

Koa is an IEB online school in South Africa for Grades 4-12 offering parents a future-focused option for their child's education. Based on a vision and framework for School 2.0, Koa provides high pupil engagement in eight-person pods with a dedicated teacher in a structured, yet individualised environment. The academic programme provides integrated learning across the South African curriculum through an innovative online platform. Pupils access carefully curated, top global

educational resources. They benefit from high levels of teacher time, ongoing, age-appropriate assessment and instant feedback through the student dashboard. Academic progress is mastery-based so that pupils can proceed at their own pace. Social and emotional development is embedded in Koa schooling experience and is facilitated daily through the small class environment. Koa focuses on learning that prepares children for real life and the development of the skills and capabilities they need to succeed in the 21st century.





'If you want to go fast, go alone. If
you want to go far, go together.'

— - *African Proverb*

Wall of Wisdom

CHALK ONE UP WITH SA Homeschooling's 'CHALKBOARD!'



If you have your own homeschooling service, whether it be social activities, caregiving services, gardening for kids' programmes, extramurals, educational games/puzzles, outdoor activity programmes and the like, then SA Homeschooling's 'Chalkboard' pages are the perfect way to get them promoted. And at an exceptionally affordable rate with fantastic exposure!

**CONTACT US
FOR MORE INFORMATION**

JENNY jenny@isikhova.co.za

RUWAYDA ruwayda@isikhova.co.za



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Varsity isn't their only option

As homeschooled matriculants are recovering from their recent final exams, many may be wondering what their next steps will be. **Eloise Nolte**, Managing Director of College SA, offers some guidance on 'where to next?'



#FUNFACT

In the United States alone, there are over 5 000 institutions for higher education.

These youngsters will soon be entering one of the toughest job markets of our time.

Now, more than ever, the decision that your soon-to-be young adults make after completing their school career is critical to their career prospects. While many still opt for university, there's an ever-growing list of exciting, quality alternatives for students who wish to follow another path.

There are also options for those who haven't managed to complete matric. This isn't the time to be disheartened about the future – it's the time for adaptation, innovation and hope.

Understanding the NQF

With a Grade 10, 11 or 12 qualification, students can move upwards in the National Qualifications Framework (NQF) levels.

In SA, the NQF is the system used to measure levels of learning. There are 10 NQF levels and they fall into three categories: the General and Further Education and Training Qualifications Sub-Framework, the Higher Educational Qualifications Sub-Framework and the Occupational Qualifications Sub-Framework.

Understanding these levels and how they work can help your child find vacancies for which they're qualified. Achieving the next NQF

NQF 10 LEVELS EXPLAINED			
CHE - Higher Education Qualifications - Sub-Framework	Doctoral Degree Doctoral Degree Professional	10	-
	Master's Degree Master's Degree Professional	9	-
	Bachelor Honours Degree Postgraduate Diploma Bachelor's Degree	8	Occupational Certificate
	Bachelor's Degree Advanced Diploma	7	Occupational Certificate
	Diplomal Advanced Certificate	6	Occupational Certificate
	Higher Certificate	5	Occupational Certificate
Umalusi - General and Further Education and Training Qualifications Sub-Framework	National Certificate Grade 12 / Standard 10 / Matric Trade Certificate	4	Occupational Certificate
	Intermediate Certificate Grade 11 Standard 9	3	Occupational Certificate
	Elementary Certificate Grade 10 Standard 8	2	Occupational Certificate
	General Certificate Grade 4-9 Standard 2-7	1	Occupational Certificate

level also doesn't necessarily involve going to university. Many of these qualifications can be achieved through distance learning, adult education and training institutions, or via technical and vocational education and training colleges.

Students can start by looking at the fields that are most in demand today and assessing whether their interests fit these fields before exploring how to go about completing the next NQF level.

Moving through the ranks

According to recent reports, applicants with skills in, for example, accounting, engineering and technology have remained among the most in demand during 2021.

School-leavers looking to enter the accounting space might be interested in studying courses

that are accredited from the well-regarded Institute of Certified Bookkeepers (ICB) or the Chartered Institute of Management Accountants (CIMA). The CIMA Business Accounting course doesn't require a matric, but it can provide students with an NQF Level 5 qualification.

When it comes to technology, IT Academy, a highly respected course provider that's part of

Optimi College, also provides a valuable software development course that covers fundamentals such as HTML5, C#, Microsoft Azure and much more. This course is certified by the likes of Microsoft and provides students with an NQF Level 5 qualification upon completion.

For many years, there's also been a severe shortage of artisans in SA. Several options exist. National trade courses in essential career paths such as boilermaking, welding, fitting and turning, electrical and the motor trade – all critical for engineering-related fields – can help students gain a foothold in the current market. These qualifications are known as N1, N2 and N3 qualifications and enable students to apply to a college to complete a Higher National Diploma afterwards.

It's important that youngsters know that there are alternatives to university. In a world that's constantly changing, traditional educational routes aren't the only answer.

To find out more, [click here](#).





Reading for joy and knowledge



For littlies

1. *Matt and Mia Meet a Bully and Matt and Mia in the Garden* (Penguin)

Your little ones will just love this delightful series by Antoinette Bradley Brown, with its adorable illustrations and easy-to-read text. A big plus are the questions at the end of each page, designed to teach young readers both the art of comprehension and the art of conversation. For example: 'Look at this page and the opposite page and answer the following questions: Where do fish live? Describe the weather. Name three things you can see in the picture.'



2. *Elephant's Big Secret* (Penguin)

Written by Wendy Maartens and illustrated by Shayna Olivier, *Elephant's Big Secret and 19 Other Fantastic Fables* teaches life lessons in the most charming way imaginable. The 20 stories are huge fun to read aloud and both reader and listener are sure to get the giggles. For example: 'One day, long ago, when Ostriches could still fly, there was a gnat. Even though he was tiny, he wasn't afraid of a single thing. That was because, right from the start, his mother had taught him he was much stronger than he thought.'

#FUNFACT

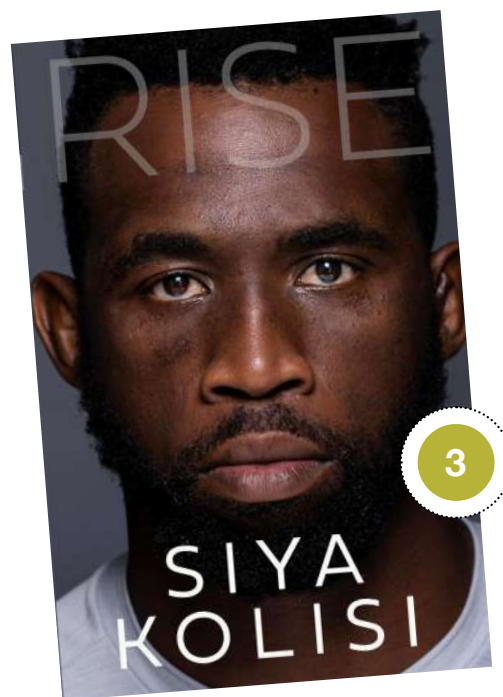
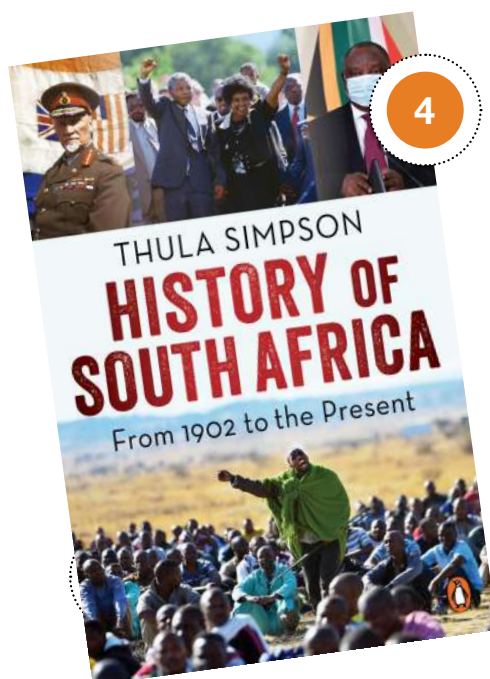
Read 20 minutes
a day and you'll read
1 800 000 words
per year.

For older readers

3. *Rise* (Harper Collins)

Siya Kolisi, captain of the Springboks and the first black man to lead his country in over 128 years of South African rugby, shares his story in this unputdownable memoir, charting his journey from being born in the impoverished Zwide township and his 2018 appointment as captain of the Springboks to leading South Africa to an astonishing victory at the Rugby World Cup in 2019 and becoming the first black captain of a World Cup-winning side.

But *Rise* isn't just a tale of matches played and won – it's an exploration of a man's race and his faith, a masterclass in attaining a positive mindset and an inspirational reminder that it's possible to defy the odds, no matter how they're stacked against you.



4. *History of South Africa* (Penguin)

This tome of a title is essential for all history students and lovers of local knowledge. *History of South Africa: From 1902 to the Present* explores the country's tumultuous journey from the aftermath of the Second Anglo-Boer War to the Covid-19 pandemic. Drawing on never-before-published documentary evidence – including diaries, letters, eyewitness testimony and diplomatic reports – the book follows the South African people through the battles, elections, repression, resistance, strikes, insurrections, massacres, economic crashes and health crises that have shaped the nation's character. It's the kind of book you'll dip into and refer to for years to come.

Every home deserves a book about everything and this treasure by master storyteller Mike Bruton is the perfect homeschooling family's reference. Here's a taste of what to expect

Mike is a retired scientist who devotes his time to sharing his knowledge and passion for science. *Curious Notions: Reflections of an Imagineer* (Footprint Press) comprises essays on aspects of science, culture and technology in which he's been involved. The thrill of scientific discovery, humorous episodes and colourful characters in the history of science, creativity in the arts and sciences are wonderful chapters!

Bruton then discusses two remarkable societies, one in England in the late 1700s that ignited the First Industrial Revolution and another in Cape Town that's spreading knowledge today. A fascinating chapter on the evolution of the bicycle follows in which its role in the invention of the motorbike, motorcar and even the airplane is described.

A chapter on 'Who is South Africa's greatest inventor?' evaluates the credentials of 15 of our most innovative scientists and technologists. Two light-hearted chapters follow, the first on the comical art of naming new animal species and the second on the author's collection of over 1 700 words ending in '-ology'. The following two chapters bring the reader up to date



on the story of the coelacanth, the ancient 'living fossil' fish first found off South Africa. After a chapter on 'Lessons from the dodo', Bruton then answers an intriguing question: Which is South Africa's strangest animal?

The penultimate chapter is on the African women and men who've won a Nobel Prize. This isn't a dry list of top achievers, but a fascinating look behind the scenes on how their upbringing led them to achieve this ultimate accolade. In the final chapter, Bruton presents his views on 'What is science?' and discusses the Fourth Industrial Revolution and the danger posed by anti-science sentiments on the Internet. This chapter is essential reading for anyone with an interest in science and society.



Pens down!

SA Homeschooling's 2021 Creative Writing Competition has come to a close with final round winners being published in this issue.

We've been so impressed and excited about all the wonderful entries received and moreover, at the incredible talent of young, budding South African authors. Well done to everyone who submitted stories, and congratulations to all the round winners.

The Grand Prize winners from each age group below will be published in Issue 8.

Creative writing competition third-round winners

Once again, children have proved that they understand the power of the pen. What a difficult task it was finding the best of the best! Don't miss the next issue in which we announce the overall winners

The adversities of self-discovery **By Nompumelelo Xaba, age 15**

It is incredibly difficult to think about the journey to self-discovery and not think about the discomfort, the desire to always improve and, above all else, the lingering insecurities as you grow older. Growing up, we are given this narrow view of what fulfilment, success and happiness look like, so that our minds are programmed to think in a certain way. We find ourselves in positions where we even question our own potential and abilities to be anything but what we have been programmed to deem as acceptable by both society and our parents.

The parameters by which success is measured are different from person to person, but we can all agree that it is commonly measured by material wealth such as lavish cars, a luxurious home, a spouse, perhaps two or more kids and, ultimately, a good job. Shying away from the fact that

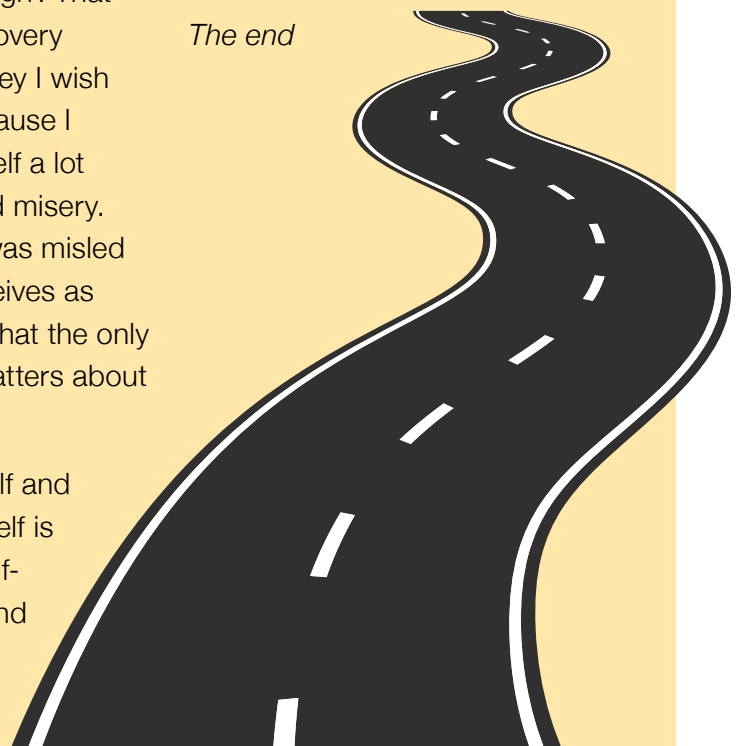
it is tremendously pressurising would be an injustice to ourselves because we spend so much time trying to be anything but ourselves that we end up losing our authenticity, which is the most beautiful thing we can embody.

It took me the past few months of my life to realise how much I could do if I looked just a few inches away from what people considered 'good enough'. That was when my self-discovery journey started, a journey I wish I'd taken ages ago because I would have saved myself a lot of self-inflicted pain and misery. For the longest time I was misled with what society perceives as acceptable, forgetting that the only opinion that actually matters about me is mine.

Learning to love yourself and everything about yourself is the first milestone in self-discovery. Be patient and kind with yourself and, ultimately, everything

will come full circle. A big part of finding yourself is accepting the past as you work towards the future. This will not happen overnight, so the journey will be long and challenging from time to time, but with every challenge comes a lesson and that is how you learn more about yourself. The adversities in self-discovery are countless, but definitely worth every little step.

The end



What the judges said

Nompumelelo shows great wisdom and we believe this message should be shared far and wide.



Mama Seeks

By Anae Labuschagne, age 11

One day I was sitting at the dinner table with my cousins, eating. When we were just about to say goodbye, my oldest cousin came up to me and whispered: 'I'm sorry.' He proceeded to pat me on the back twice. I had just realised I had joined the game of Mama Seeks and I was mortified.

I knew I was in for a ride. I turned around to see Mama Seeks breathing down my throat. I knew I had an hour before I would die. I knew I didn't want to give Mama Seeks to anyone in my family because they wouldn't know what it was. I once saw it on the Internet, but I thought it was fake.

Now I was in my bed trying to process this, but in the distance, I heard my brother's friend Ryan. Now I knew I didn't want to put a burden on my brother, but I had to. I tried to exit the house, but the door was locked and the windows disappeared. I was trembling in fear, knowing that if I didn't do this fast enough, I would die. Wanting to make up my mind, I tried hard to think. Then finally I thought that I had to do it. I asked: 'Hey, is Ryan here?' to which he replied: 'No. I'm playing with him on Fortnite.' I trembled with fear, knowing that my time was running out. I desperately wanted an axe to break down the wall. I ran to the shed. It wasn't there, but a sledgehammer was. I ran to the

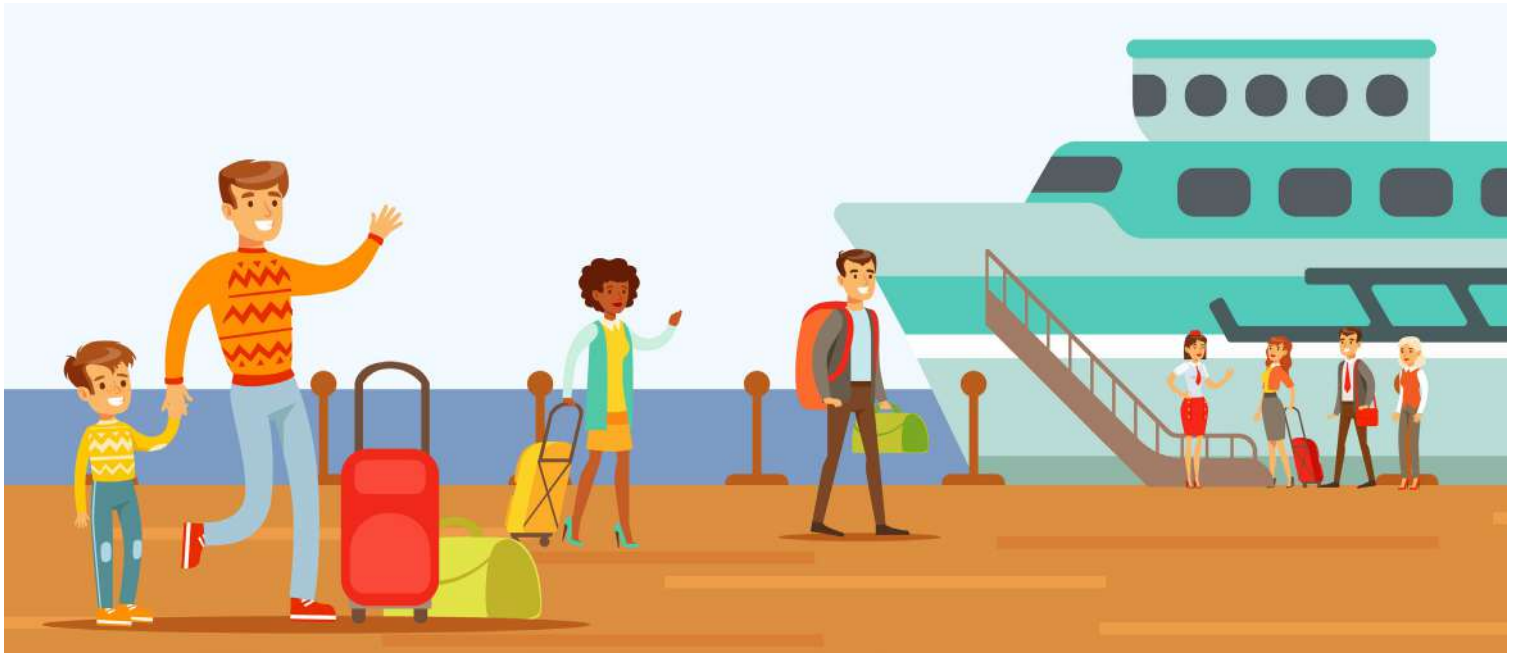
door and quickly bashed it down, but there was no dent in sight. I realised that Mama had turned the door into metal. I fell to the floor in tears. My parents came rushing to my aid and I said that it was nothing – that I had only fallen – knowing that I had five minutes left.

I looked at my watch to see when my time was up and say goodbye to my family. Where Mama Seeks takes her victims, I sat and awaited my fate. She strapped me to a hospital bed, turned into my mother and proceeded to laugh. She took out a knife and proceeded to murder me. The moment of the murder, I heard my mom saying: 'Wake up, dear! Time for school!'

The end

What the judges said

This is why night lights were invented!



My perfect holiday

By Mariam Mahomed, age 8

One year ago, I went on a cruise to Pomene, Mozambique. It was the first cruise I've been on. I was seven years old. When my parents told me about the cruise, I was jumping around and shouting. I was so excited that I couldn't wait. I went to pack my bags immediately. We had to first go to Durban before going to the cruise ship.

At 5.30 in the morning on the 14th of February, we went to the airport. There was a long way to board the plane. When we boarded the plane, I was very happy, but tired, so I slept on the way to Durban.

In Durban we went to our hotel and visited my father's grandmother.

Then we went to the beach and my great-grandmother bought me a bracelet of shells. I loved it so much. Its colour was white and light blue. Then we went to the hotel and slept. I was so excited for the next day.

The next day we caught a taxi and walked into the cruise ship entrance. We went to explore the ship. Then, when our room was ready, we went to check it out. I had fun the next day because I went to the pool and made a lot of friends. I went on a boat to Pomene. I had a bluebottle stuck on my leg. I was so scared, but my parents helped me. I went to my dad and played in the sand and when the sun was setting, we had to wait in line to go on

another boat to go back to the cruise ship. The next day I had pizza and went to the kids' area to play that night. It was the last day of the cruise and everyone dressed up because there was an Italian theme party. I had pizza again because I love pizza and there were Mario and Luigi in costumes to see everyone.

When we got off the cruise, we had to go to a hotel. We stayed there for one day, and the next day we got in an aeroplane to go home. When we got home, we were all very tired, but I just wanted to talk about my adventure. It was very exciting to go to a new place and be on the sea.

The end

What the judges said

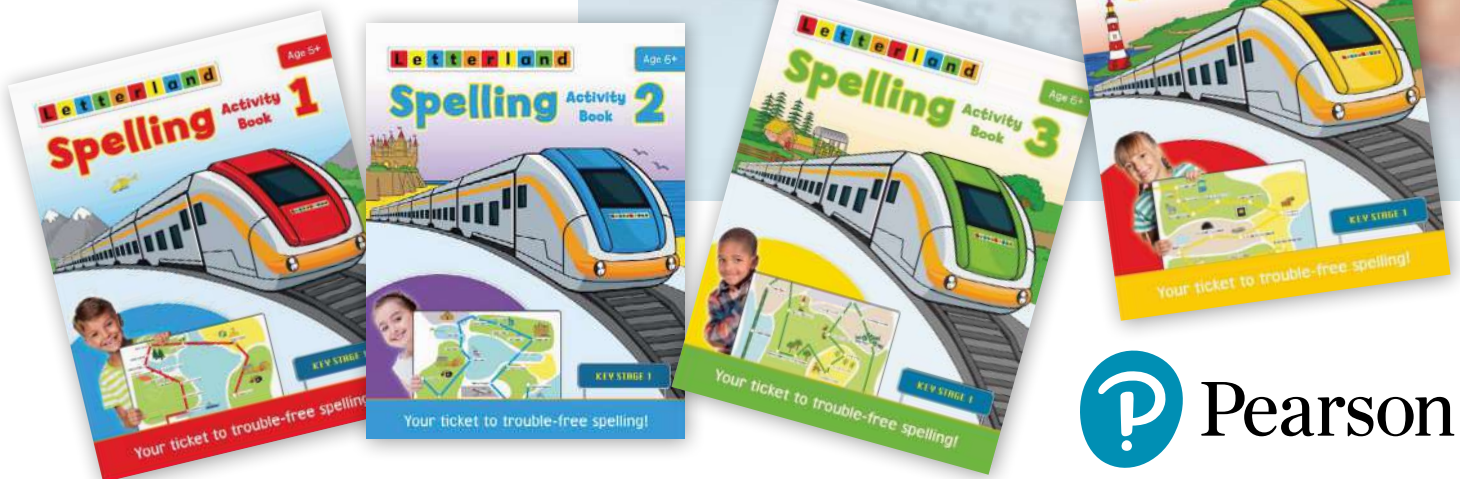
Mariam made us feel as if we were on holiday with her. What a lovely story of a lovely memory!

Your child's ticket to trouble-free spelling

Letterland is a unique, phonics-based approach to teaching reading, writing and spelling to children. Its information-rich Letterland characters transform plain black letter shapes into child-friendly pictogram characters, who live in an imaginary place called Letterland.

To give you an idea: help your child with their spelling at home by taking them on a train journey of discovery! Visual clues linked to station names give children strategies for remembering how to spell words. Supporting the National Curriculum at Key Stage 1, the illustrated step-by-step activities include filling in missing letters, matching, word searches, reading and colouring. Build confidence in spelling at primary school in this first book in a series from Letterland.

Since the company was founded 40 years ago, over a million children have learned the alphabet with Letterland using the award-winning, easy-to-follow and fun-to-use phonics titles.



STATION

Field Farm

ar

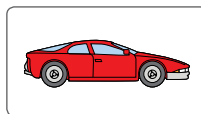
Match the tickets Draw lines to match the word and picture tickets.

market

jar

garden

car

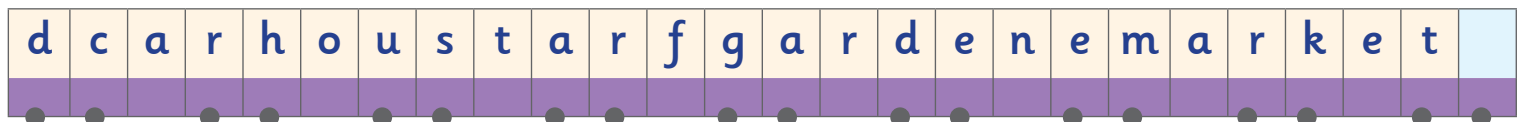


Support

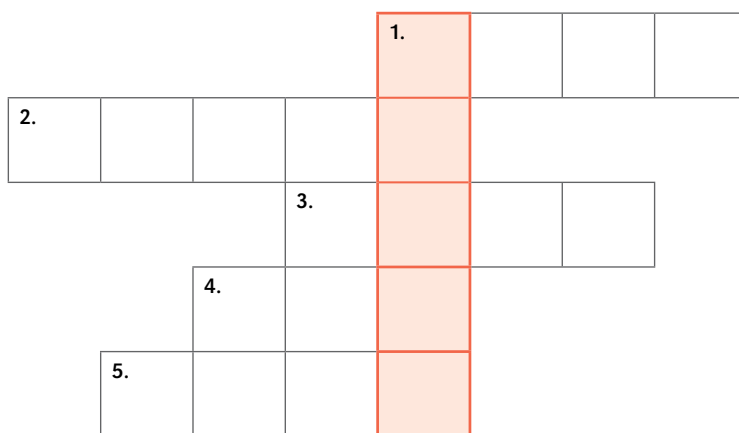
**STATION RULE**

The /ar/ sound can be spelt in different ways. For example, ar as in car, al as in calm, and a as in father.

Word train Find and circle four **ar** words in the train.



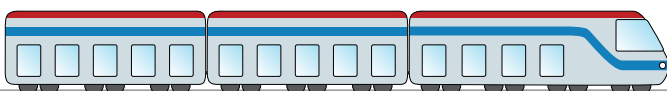
Puzzle Solve the clues to find a mystery word in the red boxes. Use the words in the box to help you.



park bark star March car

1. See this in the night sky.
2. The month before April.
3. A place to play on the swings.
4. A vehicle with four wheels.
5. The noise a dog makes.

The mystery word is:



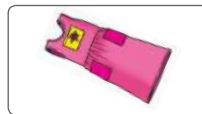
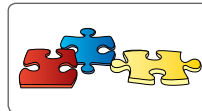
Match the tickets Draw lines to match the word and picture tickets.

dress

press

buzz

puzzle



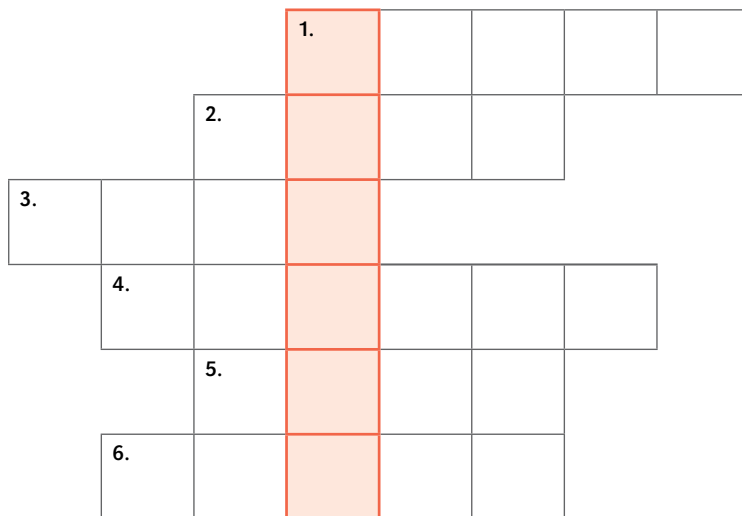
STATION RULE

The sounds /f/, /l/, /s/ and /z/ are usually spelt as **ff**, **ll**, **ss** and **zz** if they come straight after a single vowel letter (short vowel sounds), for example: coffee, shell, miss, dizzy.

Word train Find and circle four **ss** words in the train.

m i s s r o f u s s i t a h i s s e d r e s s a k

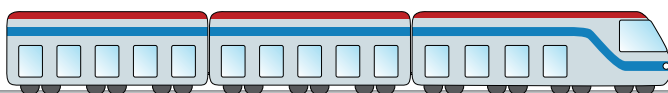
Puzzle Solve the clues to find a mystery word in the red boxes.
Use the words in the box to help you.



bell doll puffin shell cliff cuff

1. A steep rock face.
2. A toy person.
3. At the end of your arms on a shirt.
4. A bird that lives by the sea.
5. Something that can ring.
6. Find this on the beach.

The mystery word is:



FUNtastic fe

Red, gold and green
just got a whole lot more
'edible'. Merriness to all!



Fresh berry Christmas dessert



stive food

If you're looking for creative and exciting ideas for your Christmas décor, menu and table, plus a fabulous way to make fruit and veggies more appealing to your family, then feast your eyes! Of course, there simply has to be the sweet taste of success at the end of your colourful endeavours, so we've dished those up too.

(Below): Reindeer pancakes with hot chocolate and marshmallows.

(Bottom): Maki sushi roll Christmas tree.



Christmas breakfast toast with scrambled eggs



Christmas tree made of vegetables.



(Above): Toasted bread, lettuce, ham and cheese tree.

(Left): Sandwiches with cucumber slices and white cheese.

